H-B-56A
May 22, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. H-B-56
December 8, 1931

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BROOMS, UPRIGHT, COARSE FIBERS
(VEGETABLE FIBER AND SYNTHETIC FIBER)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers sturdy upright brooms made of coarse fibers. Brooms made of lighter weight broomcorn are covered in Federal Specification H-B-51 (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Classes and sizes. Fiberbrooms covered by this specification shall be of one type and the following classes and sizes, as specified.

Class 1 - Bass fiber (see 3.1.1.1).

Size 1 - 28 pounds per dozen.
Size 2 - 32 pounds per dozen.
Size 3 - 36 pounds per dozen.

Class 2 - Polypropylene fiber (see 3.1.1.2).

Size 1 - 26 pounds per dozen.
Size 2 - 27 pounds per dozen.
Size 3 - 30 pounds per dozen.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation to bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

H-B-51 - Broom, Upright (Corn).
H-S-951 - Synthetic Filaments for Brushes; General Specifications For.
T-R-650 - Rope, Yarn and Twine, Base Fiber.
T-T-871 - Twine, Cotton, Wrapping.
T-T-911 - Twine, Jute.
T-T-1613 - Twine, Olefin, Polypropylene.
CCC-C-429 - Cloth, Osnaburg, Cotton.
CCC-C-467 - Cloth, Burlap, Jute (or Kenaf).
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Govvrnment may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Office in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

FSC 7920

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

D 2016 - Tests for Moisture content of wood.
D 2256 - Strength and elongation of yarn (single strand method).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

Commercial Standards:

CS 35-61 - Hardwood Plywood.

(Copies of Commercial Standards, which are Department of Commerce Publications may be obtained upon application accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Traffic Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical Society and Technical association specifications and stands are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Fibers.

3.1.1.1 Vegetable fibers. Vegetable fibers for the broom body shall be stiff African bass, properly combed and mixed.

3.1.1.2 Synthetic fibers, class 2. Synthetic fibers for the broom body shall be polypropylene in accordance with class P, level or crimped, in H-S-951, except that fibers shall be X-shaped or clover-leaf-shaped in cross section. Hollow fibers are not acceptable. The wave amplitude of crimped filaments shall not exceed 0.86 inch and the crimp frequency shall not exceed 1 full wave per inch. The diameters of the filaments shall be as specified in table III. The color of the filaments shall be brown.

3.1.2 Bonding agent. The bonding agent for the capped portion of the fibers shall be a suitable adhesive or setting compound that will not soften or deteriorate in any way that will permit loss of fibers from the broom body or easy removal of the fibers by hand (see 4.2.2.2, table V).

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3.1.3 Metal caps. Metal caps for brooms constructed as specified in 3.3.2 method 1, shall be cold-rolled low-carbon steel, minimum thickness 0.025 inch. The steel shall be coated with enamel or lacquer, or zinc or cadmium plated to resist corrosion.

3.1.4 Plastic caps. Plastic caps for brooms constructed as specified in 3.3.2 method 2, shall be one-piece flexible molded polypropylene or polyvinyl chloride.

3.1.5 Metal parts. Except where otherwise specified herein (see 3.1.3), exposed metal parts such as rivets, nails, staple wire, and metal bands shall be corrosion resisting steel, or steel made corrosion resisting by zinc or cadmium coating or electroplating. In addition, metal parts shall be in conformance with the requirements in 3.1.5.1 through 3.1.5.5.

3.1.5.1 Rivets. Rivets shall be not less than 3/16 inch in diameter.

3.1.5.2 Broom nails. Broom nails shall be not less than size 12.

3.1.5.3 Staple wire. Staple wire shall be high carbon steel wire, hard drawn, not less than 0.0622 inch in diameter.

3.1.5.4 Round metal band. The metal band for holding the broom body in place shall be low carbon steel not less than 0.145 inch in diamter.

3.1.5.5 Flat metal band. The flat metal band for brooms constructed as specified in 3.3.2, method 2, shall be not less than 2 inches wide and not less than 0.120 inch thick (30 gage).

3.1.6 Wood for handles. Unless otherwise specified, wood for handles may be any of the following species at the option of the manufacturer: High or medium density beech, birch, pecan, or maple as classified in Commercial Standard CS 35-61; ramin, southern yellow pine, or pirana pine (see 6.4). The wood shall be straight-grained, thoroughly seasoned, and free from defects that could mar its appearance or affect its serviceability (see 4.2.2.2, table V). The moisture content of wood handles shall not exceed 15 percent when tested as specified in 4.2.1.1.

3.1.7 Finish on handles. Handles of southern yellow pine or pirana pine shall be finished with at least two coates of clear lacquer or varnish. Other woods may be uncoated.

3.1.8 Broom twine. At the option of the manufacturer, broom twine for tying the broom fibers in place shall be one of the following twines:

(1) Hemp (cannabis sativa), uniformly spun and polished.
(2) Mixture of hemp (cannabis sativa) and not more than 25 percent jute (corchorus capsularis or corchorus olitorius), uniformly spun and polished.
(3) Cotton twine.
(4) Polypropylene twine, continuous filament or twisted slit film of sufficient pliability to be used in equipment for sewing brooms.

3.1.8.1 Twine from vegetable fibers. Twines specified in (1), (2), and (3) of 3.1.8 shall meet the requirements in table I when tested by the applicable methods specified in table IV.

TABLE I. Requirements for twine made of vegetable fiber

Characteristic		Values for: Hemp (1)	Hemp and Jute (2)	Cotton(3)
Size designation		18	18	-
Number of plies, minimum		3	3	3
Length per pound, minimum,	feet	1100	1100	1100
Breaking strength, minimum,	pounds	42	42	42

3.1.8.2 Polyproyplene twine. Polypropylene twine specified in (4) of 3.1.8 shall meet the requirements in table II when tested by the applicable methods specified in table IV.

TABLE II. Requirements for polypropylene twine

Characteristic		Value
Number of plies, minimum		3
Length per pound, minimum,	feet	2700
Softening point, minimum,	F	310-320
Breaking strength:		
Original, minimum,	pounds	42.0
After aging, permissible decrease	percent	10
Elongation, maximum,	percent	20
Loop strength, minimum,	pounds	24
Finishing material, maximum	percent	4.0

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3.2 Design. Brooms shall be designed similar to figure 1 and 2. The illustrations show the steel cap and steel band construction only. Brooms with plastic caps and two rows of stitching as specified in table III are equally acceptable.

3.3 Construction. Brooms shall be in accordance with the physical requirements in table III and shall be construed as specified in 3.3.1 through 3.3.5.

TABLE III. Physical requirements for fiber brooms

Characteristics		Size 1		Size 2		Size 3	
		Class 1	Class 2	Class 1	Class 2	Class 1	Class 2
		Bass fiber	Polypropylene fiber	Bass fiber	Polypropylene fiber	Bass fiber	Polypropylene fiber
Broom body:							
Length out of cap, min.	in.	9-3/4	9-3/4	9-3/4	9-3/4	9-3/4	9-3/4
Width at sweeping end	do.	11 - 12½	11 - 12½	11 - 12½	11 - 12½	11 - 12½	11 - 12½
Hold of fibers in cap min.	do.	1-1/2	1-1/2	1-1/2	1-1/2	1-1/2	1-1/2
Width at base of cap	do.	6-1/4 - 7	6-1/4 - 7	6-1/4 - 7	6-1/4 - 7	6-1/4 - 7	6-1/4 - 7
Handle:							
Length out of cap , min.	in.	40	40	40	40	40	40
Diameter, min.	do.	15/16	15/16	1	1	1	1
Extension into broom body	in.	2	2	2	2	2	2
Ties:							
Number of rows of ties, min.		2	2	2	2	2	2
Distance of first tie from base of cap min.	in.	1-3/4	1-3/4	1-3/4	1-3/4	1-3/4	1-3/4
Distance between ties, min.	do.	5/8	5/8	5/8	5/8	5/8	5/8
Number of stitches per tie,	min.	9	9	9	9	9	9
Weight per dozen, unpacked, dry, min.	lb.	27	24	31	25	35	28
Fibers, synthetic:							
Average minor diameter	in.		0.050[a]		0.050[a]		0.050[a]
Minor diameter of individual fibers	in.						
Minimum			0.020		0.020		0.020
Maximum			0.070		0.070		0.70

a. Permissible tolerance on average minor diameter is ± 0.005 inch.

3.3.1 Broom body. The broom body shall consist of class 1 bass fibers (3.1.1.1), or class 2 polypropylene fibers (3.1.1.2), as specified (see 1.2.1). The body of class 2 polypropylene fiber brooms shall consist of a mixture of fibers of different diameters within the limits specified in table III that will produce a broom simulating the stiffness of class 1 bass fiber brooms, or the fibers may be of the same diameter at the option of the manufacturer.

3.3.2 Fastening of fibers in broom body. Prior to capping, the portion of the fibers to be covered shall be secured by one of the following methods:

(1) By an adhesive or a setting compound (3.1.2).
(2) By binding with a steel band not less than 0.120 inch thick (3.1.5.5) and compressing in a 15 to 20 ton press.

3.3.3 Capping of fibers.

3.3.3.1 Metal cap. Fibers secured by method (1) of 3.3.2, shall be capped by one of the following methods: (1) By through riveting with at least five equally spaced rivets, or nailed with at least five equally spaced nails strengthened and protected by extra covering, or (2) by a two-piece metal cap secured to the broom body by overlapping clinched seams, and to the handle by pierced extrusions, two on each side, that are driven into the handle when the press closes. The cap shall be free from protuberances or sharp edges that could cause injury to the user.

3.3.3.2 Plastic cap. Brooms secured by method (2) of 3.3.2 shall be capped by one of the plastic materials specified in 3.1.4. The cap shall be secured to the handle by a suitable epoxy resin adhesive or secured to the broom body by a 5/8 inch wide staple on each side.

3.3.4 Tying and stitching of broom body. The body of each broom shall be held in place by ties and stitches of the twine in 3.1.8.1 or 3.1.8.2 at the option of the manufacturer, or in lieu of twine, by a spot-welded metal band (3.1.5 and 3.1.5.4), as shown in figure 1, securely locked to the fibers by at least three equally spaced staples (3.1.5 and 3.1.5.3). Ends of twine shall be adequately secured.

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3.3.5 Handle. Handles shall be wood as specified in 3.1.6. The dimensions of handles and the length of extension into the capped portion of the broom body shall be as specified in table III. Handles shall be straight (see 4.2.2.2, table V). Southern yellow pine and pirana pine handles shall be coated as specified in 3.1.6. Coating of other handles shall be option to the manufacturer.

3.4 Marking. Each broom shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such character as is readily identifiable, or both.

3.5 Workmanship. Brooms shall be free from defects which affect appearance and may affect serviceability or durability and shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Component and materials inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with requirements of referenced specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.1.1 Moisture content of handles. For the purpose of inspection, the lot shall consist of all handles of one type and size prepared under the same conditions, stored as a group, and offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one handle. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective. Handles shall be tested for moisture content by method B of ASTM D 2016. Three determinations shall be made on each handle. If any handle in the sample test unit fails to meet the requirement for moisture content in 3.1.6, it shall be considered defective. If the number of defective handles in the sample exceeds the acceptance number in MIL-STD-105, the entire lot of handles shall be considered as failed to meet the requirement of the specification.

4.2.1.2 Inspection of broom twine. For the purpose of testing twine, a lot shall consist of all twine of the same kind (see 3.1.8) offered for delivery at one time. The lot size shall be expressed in pounds. The sample unit for testing shall be approximately 60 feet of twine. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the acceptable quality level 4.0 percent defective. Unless otherwise specified in table IV, broom twine shall be tested by the applicable method in Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 specified therein for conformance with the applicable requirements in table I and II. Tests may be made under prevailing atmospheric condition except in settlement of dispute, in which case they shall be made upon material which has reached equilibrium under standard conditions as defined in Federal Test Method Standard No. 191. If any sample unit fails to meet any requirement for which tests are made, it shall be considered defective. If the number of defective sample units in the sample for test exceeds the acceptance number in MIL-STD-105, the entire lot of twine shall be considered as having failed to meet the requirements of this specification.

TABLE IV. Test methods for broom twine

Characteristics	Test Method	No. of Specimens
Number of plies	Visual	1
Softening point	1533	2
Length per pound	6004	2
Breaking strength:		
Original	6016	5
After aging	6016	5
Elongation	6016	5
Heat aging	Note a	3
Loop strength	ASTM D 2256, option C loop breaking load	
Nonfibrous material, chloroform and water soluble	2611	2

a. Five specimens shall be aged for five days in a circulating air oven at a temperature of 80° ± 1.1°C. (176° ± 2°F.). The specimens shall be removed from the oven, conditioned for 24 hours in a standard atmosphere for textiles, and subjected to breaking strength test method 6016.

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4.2.2 End item inspection.

4.2.2.1 Lot. All brooms of the same size and class shall be considered to be a lot for the purpose of examination and testing.

4.2.2.2 Visual examination of the end item. Brooms shall be examined visually for defects listed in table V. The sample unit shall be one broom. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) 10.0 defects per 100 units. If the number of defects in the sample exceeds the acceptance number specified in MIL-STD-105, the entire lot of brooms shall be considered as having failed to meet the requirements of the specification.

TABLE V. Visual defects

Examination	Defects
Materials:	
Vegetable fibers	Not stiff African bass as specified in 3.1.1.1.
Polypropylene fibers	Not as specified in 3.1.1.2
Twine	Not as specified in 3.1.8
Plastic cap	Not one piece molded flexible plastic as specified in 3.1.4.
Metal cap	Not steel finished as specified in 3.1.3. Coating uneven, chipped, or cracked. Metal exposed.
Wood handle	Wood not as specified in 3.1.6. Handle not straight. Warp or bow more than 3/8 inch when handle is rotated on a flat surface. Any season, fracture, or split, open or visibly concealed by filler. Splinters, pitch, knot holes, loose knots, sound knots over 1/2 inch in diamter, or other imperfections affecting serviceability.
Rivets, nails, staples, and wire bands.	Not as specified in 3.1.5 through 3.1.5.5, as applicable.
Constructions:	
Metal cap construction	Not secured to handle and broom body as specified in 3.3.3.1.
Plastic cap construction	Not secured to handle and broom body as specified in 3.3.3.2.
Broom body	Fibers or filaments can be easily removed by handle. Fibers or filaments do not form a desne working surface. Fiber or filaments not evenly trimmed - edges jagged or sawtooth. Ties loose - do not hold broom body in place. Ends of twine not properly secured. Twine damaged - weak spots or cuts. Less than required number of stitched rows; less than required number of stitches per row. Steel band not properly secured so that it remains in place.
Marking	Not as specified in 3.4.
Workmanship	Not as specified in 3.5.

4.2.2.3 Dimensional examination of the end item. Brooms shall be examined for conformance with the dimensional requirements in table III. The sample unit shall be one broom. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level 2.5 percent defective. If any sample unit fails to meet any dimensional requirement in table III it shall be considered defective. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number in MIL-STD-105, the entire lot of brooms shall be considered as having failed to meet the requirements of the specification.

4.2.2.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determined whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table VI. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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TABLE VI. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity per container or bundle is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements of the box specification.

4.2.2.5 Testing of the end item. Brooms shall be tested as specified in 4.3.1 through 4.3.2.3. The sample unit for weight per dozen shall be twelve brooms taken at random from the lot. The sample unit for tests of polypropylene fibers shall be one broom. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be as follows:

Tests	Inspection Levels	Acceptable Quality Levels Percent Defective
Weight per dozen (4.3.1)	S-2	10.0
Tests of polypropylene fibers (4.3.2 through 4.3.2.3)	S-2	4.0

4.3 Test procedures.

4.3.1 Weight per dozen brooms. Twelve brooms taken from the lot as specified in 4.2.2.5 shall be weighed on a suitable scale, accurate to 1/4 pound and the weight recorded to nearest 1/4 pound. The results shall be checked for conformance with the applicable requirement in table III.

4.3.2 Tests for polypropylene fibers.

4.3.2.1 Diameter of crimped filaments. The indicated diameter (minor diameter) of individual fibers shall be determined as specified in H-S-951 (see figure 3). Each value shall be recorded and checked for conformance with the minimum and maximum values in table III herein. The individual values shall be averaged and the result checked for conformance with the average value in table III.

4.3.2.2 Wave amplitude and crimp frequency. The wave amplitude and crimp frequency of the fibers shall be determined by the applicable test method in H-S-951 and the results checked for conformance with the requirements in 3.1.1.2.

4.3.2.3 Melting point and specific gravity. The melting point and specific gravity of polypropylene fibers shall be determined by the applicable test method in H-S-951 and the results checked for conformance with the requirements therein.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The brooms shall be packed as specified in 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2 (see 6.2).

5.1.1.1 Bundling. Twelve brooms shall be securely tied together with cotton, hemp, jute or polypropylene twine passed through the broom bodies. Cotton twine shall be a minimum of 24 ply and conform to T-T-871. Hemp, jute and polypropylene twine shall have a minimum breaking strength of 40 pounds and shall conform to T-R-650, T-T-911 and T-T-1613 as applicable. The broom handles shall be securely fastened together with a 16-gage wire which shall be looped around at least one of the handles to prevent slipping. The broom bodies shall be covered by wrapping or by drawing a presewn skirt or tubing, with seamed top, down over the handles onto the broom bodies. Material used for the covering shall be either osnaburg cotton conforming to CCC-C-429, class 3, or burlap conforming to CCC-C-467, class 1. The skirt or tubing shall be closed by sewing with 16-ply twine conforming to T-T-871 or by gathering together and securing with two wire ties. The stitches shall be approximately 1 inch to 1-1/2 inches in length and each stitch shall be knotted. The wire ties shall be fabricated from 15-gage soft iron or steel with a 1/2 inch diameter eye at each end.

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5.1.1.2 Boxing. Twelve brooms shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, grade V3c, V3s or V4s, style FOL or FPF. In packing, the broom bodies and handles shall be alternately reversed. The sides of the box shall be ventilated with four slots one-fourth of an inch wide by 2 inches long in each side. The slots shall be positioned in pairs, with one pair 18 inches from each end and the second pair 21 inches from each end. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636. The slots shall not be required for boxes containing class 2 brooms.

5.1.2 Level B. The brooms shall be packed as specified in 5.1.2.1 or 5.1.2.2 (see 6.2).

5.1.2.1 Bundling. Twelve brooms shall be bundled in accordance with 5.1.1.1.

5.1.2.2 Boxing. Twelve brooms shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, grade 275, style FOL or FPF. In packing, the broom bodies and handles shall be alternately reversed. The sides of the box shall be vented as specified in 5.1.1.2. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.3 Level C. The brooms shall be packed to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination in compliance with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.2 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.2.1 or 5.2.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Brooms are intended for use in wet or dry sweeping of rough surfaced areas, such as brick and concrete, to remove heavy and dense debris.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Class and size required (1.2.1).
(c) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (5.1).
(d) Marking (5.2).

6.3 Class 2 - Polypropylene brooms are intended for use as an alternate for bass fiber brooms.

6.4 For information regarding ramin and pirana pine, see U.S. Forest Service Research Note FPL 125, March 1970, "Properties of Imported Tropical Woods," by Francis Kukachka, Botanist, Forest Products Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Madison, WI 53705.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

User activities:
Army - GL

DOD has waived coordination on revisions and amendments to this Federal Specification until further notice

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:
GSA-FSS

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

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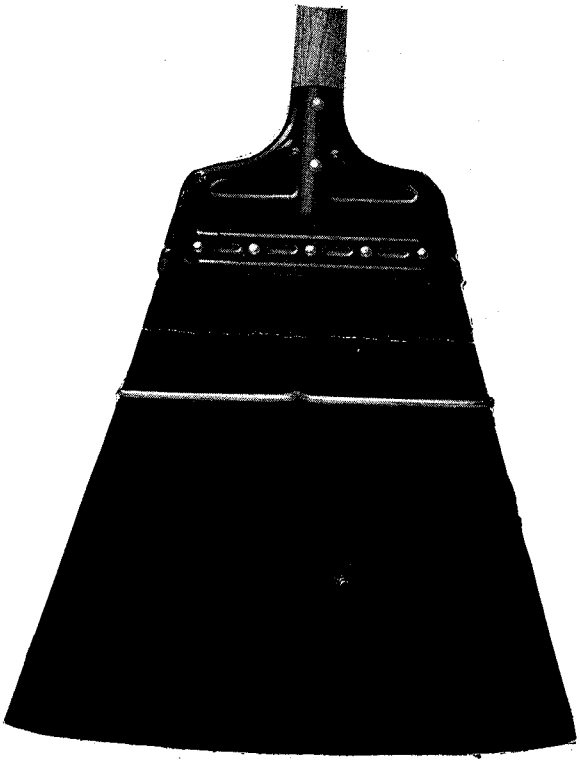


FIGURE 1. Vegetable fiber broom

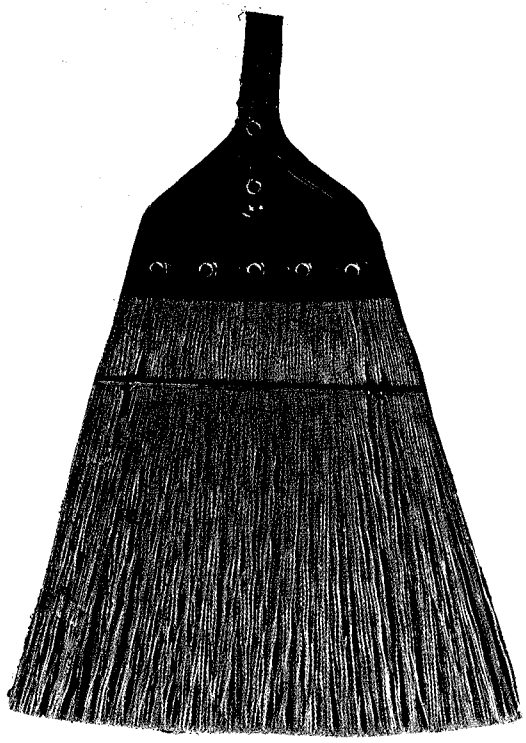
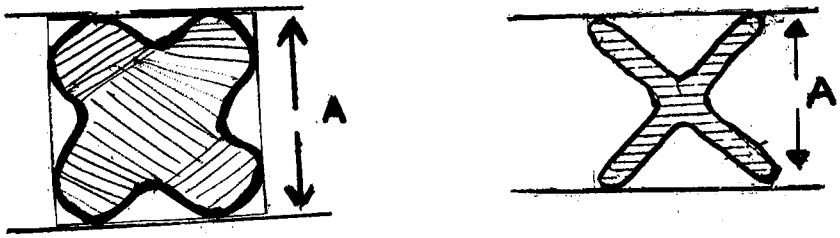


FIGURE 2. Polypropylene fiber broom

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CLOVERLEAF X-SHAPED

A = Indicated diameter

FIGURE 3 - Magnified cross section of polypropylene fibers

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